

Architecture Careers — Comparable Evidence



NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Read the Labels

All pay figures below are **May 2024 U.S. median annual wages from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics**. Median is not starting pay, DFW pay, or a guarantee.

CAREER	WORK PRODUCT	COMMON PREPARATION	MAY 2024 U.S. MEDIAN
Architect	Plans and designs structures; coordinates project requirements	Bachelor's degree is the BLS typical entry education. Registration requirements vary; common Texas structure includes approved education, documented AXP experience, and ARE.	\$96,690
Drafter	Converts designs into technical drawings with CAD software	Associate's degree is the BLS typical entry education; certificate or diploma routes also exist.	\$65,380
Interior Designer	Plans functional, safe, and attractive interior spaces and documents selections/layouts	Bachelor's degree is the BLS typical entry education; registration rules vary by work and jurisdiction.	\$63,490

Sources accessed August 2026: BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook profiles for Architects, Drafters, and Interior Designers; NCARB/Texas sources for architecture registration structure.

Compare the Work and Preparation

CAREER	ONE DAILY WORK PRODUCT	EDUCATION/PREPARATION EVIDENCE	EXPERIENCE, EXAM, REGISTRATION, OR OTHER BOUNDARY
Architect			
Drafter			
Interior Designer			

One preparation difference that matters to me:

Compare the Salaries

Keep the label with every figure.

RANK	CAREER	MAY 2024 U.S. MEDIAN	DIFFERENCE FROM THE NEXT CAREER
1			
2			
3			—

What can this evidence support?

What can it **not** support about DFW, starting pay, or a guarantee?

Optional Xello local cross-check: occupation _____ geography _____
measure _____ date/year _____ value _____

Evidence-Based Recommendation

Fictional Jordan values design and wants to compare the amount/type of preparation before choosing a career to investigate further.

My recommendation: _____

Salary evidence with complete label:

Preparation evidence:

Why these two pieces of evidence support the recommendation:

One limitation or question Jordan should investigate next: